

Positron Emission Tomography (NaF-18) to Identify Bone Metastasis of Cancer

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

220.6.19

Manual Section Title

Positron Emission Tomography (NaF-18) to Identify Bone Metastasis of Cancer

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

12/15/2021

Implementation Date

01/17/2022

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

Positron Emission Tomography (PET) is a minimally-invasive, diagnostic imaging procedure that assesses the level of metabolic activity and perfusion in various organ systems of the body. A positron camera (tomograph) is used to produce cross-sectional tomographic images, which are obtained from positron-emitting radioactive tracer substances (radiopharmaceuticals) such as F-18 sodium fluoride (NaF-18).

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

The confirmatory analyses were not published during the 24-month time period. Therefore, effective December 15, 2017, CMS determines that there are no nationally covered indications for PET NaF-18.

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

Effective December 15, 2017, CMS determines that PET NaF-18 PET is nationally non-covered.

D. Other

Other PET radiopharmaceutical tracers for cancer can be covered at local Medicare Administrative Contractor discretion when used according to their FDA-approved indication(s).

(This NCD last reviewed December 2017.)

Cross Reference

[CED page](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

11158

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/files/document/r11158ncd.pdf> 

Revision History

06/2022 - Transmittal 10832, dated June 2, 2021, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11453, dated, June 10, 2022, to revise NCD 90.2, NGS, revises business requirement 12124.2 and 12124.2.1 and its associated spreadsheet of coding by retaining all ICD-10 NOC diagnosis codes proposed for deletion effective July 1, 2022. ([TN 11453](#) ) (CR12124)

12/2021 - The purpose for this change request is to update the NCD manual language to reflect that effective December 15, 2017, following the 24-month extension and absent any published, peer-reviewed journals regarding PET NaF-18 to identify bone metastases of cancer, NCD 220.6.19 reverted to a non-coverage determination. ([TN 11158](#) ) (CR12526)

06/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10832](#) ) (CR12124)

05/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10804](#) ) (CR12124)

03/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10624](#)) (CR12124)

02/2020 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, longstanding NCD process. ([TN 2439](#)) (CR11655)

03/2013 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/07/2013 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1199](#)) (CR 8197)

03/2010 - CMS proposes that the evidence is not sufficient to determine that the results of NaF-18 PET imaging to identify bone metastases improve health outcomes of beneficiaries with cancer. Therefore CMS proposes that this use is not reasonable and necessary under Section 1862(a)(1)(A) of the Social Security Act (the Act). Effective date: 02/26/2010. Implementation date: 07/06/2010. ([TN 119](#)) (CR6861)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [First reconsideration for Positron Emission Tomography \(NaF-18\) to Identify Bone Metastasis of Cancer \(CAG-00065R\)](#)
- [Second reconsideration for Positron Emission Tomography \(NaF-18\) to Identify Bone Metastasis of Cancer \(CAG-00065R2\)](#)

Additional Information

[Other Versions](#)

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